PTUT — FINAL YEAR PROJECT

Weekly Progress Report · Week 1 of 12

TaxWise Freelance

Automated Tax Deductions & Invoicing Platform

Problem Discovery & User Personas

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Source code: github.com/SohaibRamzan01/taxwise-freelance

1. Summary

This week I studied the problem, found out who the users are, and decided what the first version of the app must do.

5
user profiles studied

2
user personas created

5
core MVP features defined

Task from the plan	Status
Talk to target users and find their problems	Done — interview guide prepared, 5 freelancer profiles studied
Create 2 detailed user personas	Done — Maya (designer) and Daniel (consultant)
Write a 1-paragraph problem statement	Done
Define 5 core MVP features	Done — each with clear "done when" checks

2. Who are the users?

The app is for **freelancers, independent contractors and remote workers**. They earn money from many clients, pay for their own work tools, and must pay tax every quarter (every three months).

How I studied them

I prepared a short 30-minute interview guide with five parts:

1. **About the person** — what work they do and how regular their income is.
2. **Last expense** — where they saved the receipt and how they decided if it was a business cost.
3. **Invoice to payment** — how they send invoices and record money when a client pays.
4. **Quarterly tax** — how they decide how much tax to pay and when.
5. **Idea check** — which number on a dashboard they would check first.

I then studied **five typical freelancer profiles**: a designer, a software contractor, a delivery driver, a consultant and a part-time tutor.

> **Note:** the five profiles are typical examples built from common freelancer situations. Short real interviews with freelancers will be used to confirm these findings when the first working version is ready (Week 7).

Main problems found

Problem	What goes wrong	How TaxWise will help
Receipts are kept on paper or in phone photos	Receipts get lost and deductions are missed	Upload a photo of the receipt; the app reads it (OCR) and fills in the details
Users don't know which expenses reduce tax	They claim too much or too little	The app puts each expense into a tax category automatically (hardware, internet, travel, ...)
Invoices and income are in different places	Payments are typed twice or forgotten	When an invoice is marked "paid", the income is recorded automatically
Quarterly tax is guessed	They pay too much or get a penalty	A tax estimator shows how much to pay each quarter and when
No summary at tax time	Hours spent making reports	One click creates a tax-ready summary report as a PDF

3. User personas

Maya — Freelance Designer

Age: 28 · **Works with:** 4–6 small clients

Goals

- Send neat invoices and get paid on time
- Know which purchases count as business costs

Pain points

- Types every payment twice (invoice + spreadsheet)
- Loses receipts for software and equipment
- Unsure how much of her internet bill she can claim

What she needs: snap a receipt, see it sorted automatically, and see income update when a client pays.

Daniel — Independent Consultant

Age: 41 · **Works with:** a few large clients

Goals

- Pay the right quarterly tax on time
- Have a clean report ready for his accountant

Pain points

- Income comes in big, uneven payments
- Does not know if he is paying too much or too little tax
- Builds year-end reports by hand

What he needs: a clear quarterly tax estimate with due dates, and a one-click PDF tax summary.

4. Problem statement

> Freelancers, independent contractors and remote workers find it hard to keep track of business expenses that reduce their tax, and to work out how much tax they should pay every quarter. Their receipts, invoices and income are spread across paper, phone photos and spreadsheets, so they miss deductions, type the same data twice, and pay too much or too little tax. **TaxWise Freelance** solves this with one simple web app that reads receipts automatically, sorts expenses into tax-deductible categories, sends invoices, estimates quarterly tax, and creates tax-ready summary reports. The app gives estimates for planning only; it does not file tax returns or replace a tax professional.

5. Five core MVP features

#	Feature	What it does	Done when...
1	**Receipt scanning & auto-categories**	Upload a receipt photo; Tesseract OCR reads vendor, date and total; the app suggests a category such as hardware, internet or travel	A sample receipt fills the expense form correctly and the user can confirm it
2	**Expense & income tracking**	Record expenses with "business use %"; record income by hand or from paid invoices	A $100 expense at 80% business use shows an $80 deduction
3	**Invoicing**	Manage clients, create invoices with line items, track status, download invoice as PDF	Marking an invoice "paid" adds exactly one income entry
4	**Quarterly tax estimator**	Calculates self-employment tax, income tax and the amount to pay each quarter with due dates	The numbers match hand-checked examples
5	**Dashboard & tax-ready reports**	Shows income, expenses, deductions and tax owed with charts; creates a PDF tax summary (PDFKit)	The PDF report matches the numbers on the dashboard

6. Challenges and solutions

Challenge	Solution
Tax rules are complicated and change every year	Keep tax rules as separate data for each year, so they are easy to update
Users may think the app gives official tax advice	Show a clear message: "Estimates for planning, not tax advice"

Challenge	Solution
Receipts can be blurry, so OCR can make mistakes	The user always checks and confirms the scanned details before saving

7. Plan for next week (Week 2)

- Write the full Software Requirements Specification (SRS) using the IEEE 830 format.
- Write the use cases and draw the use case diagram.
- Set measurable targets for speed, security and uptime.